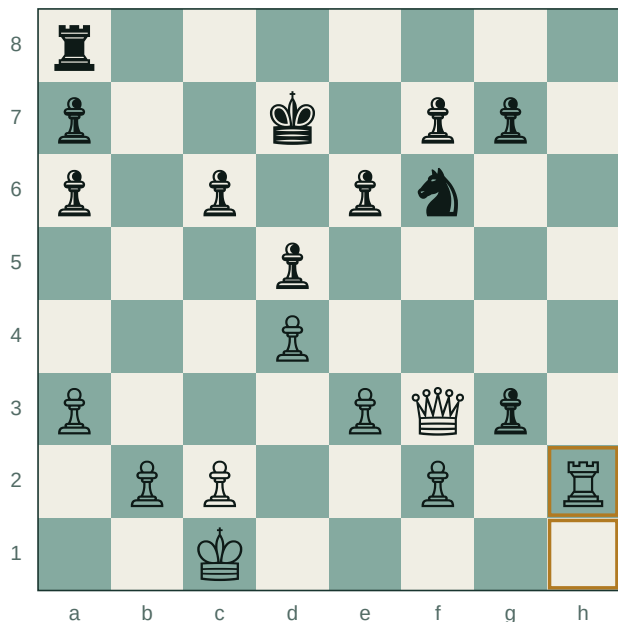


Advanced-pawn tactics: Black, move 20

Advanced-pawn tactics

Black to move



Previous move: 20.Rxh2. Gold borders mark its start and finish.

WORKED CONTINUATION - COVER THIS SECTION FIRST

20...gxh2 21. Qh3 Ng4

20...gxh2 The pawn captures the rook on h2. Recorded reply: **21.Qh3**.

21...Ng4 The knight moves from f6 to g4.

At the end, nominal material is White 15 / Black 16 (P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9). Over this line, Black's balance changes by +5. Activity and king safety still affect the evaluation.

CHECKPOINT

Using P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9, how much does Black's material balance change over the complete line? **Answer: +5:** the balance goes from -4 to +1. Count promotions and every recapture, not just the first gain.

CARRY THE IDEA INTO YOUR GAMES

A far-advanced pawn may be weak if unsupported. Check whether the opponent can capture it with tempo or blockade it permanently.

WHAT THIS POSITION TEACHES

A pawn near promotion forces the defender to respect urgent threats. Its strength can create forks, deflections, or mating ideas even when it never actually promotes.

HOW TO LOOK

Count the remaining pushes and identify the blocker. Look for forcing moves that remove or distract that blocker.

The defending king is on c1. Geometrically undefended: queen on f3 and rook on h2. Check for tactical protection.